



The next decade promises to be one of continued innovation, as digitisation and regionalisation reshape media consumption

| 131

a fragmented cinema exhibition market dominated by single-screen theatres. However, chains like PVR, INOX, and Cinapolis began acquiring smaller theatres and expanding their footprint across the country.

Now, the same trend is likely to shape the streaming industry. We have already seen the first of the big moves with Jio acquiring Star and consolidating Voot. There are still several significant streaming apps across regions and languages that have an opportunity to grow through acquisition or be a part of a larger platform. The scale benefits will become hard to ignore.

3. Regionalisation

Regionalisation continues to be the engine that drives the growth of India's M&E industry. As it looks to better monetise Tier II and III cities

as well as rural India, regional content is no longer a niche—apparent in the print industry where regional print drives growth and is a significant contributor to profitability.

The film industry has also seen a major shift toward regional content, particularly in languages like Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam, Bengali, and Punjabi. While Bollywood has traditionally been the dominant force, regional cinema has grown exponentially in both popularity and revenue, even breaking into traditional Hindi film markets.

In the OTT space, over 50% of all streaming content is now regional. Regional platforms have proliferated not just in major markets like Bengal, Telangana, Gujarat, and Maharashtra, but also in smaller markets like Meghalaya and Odisha. In addition, almost all the major platforms have a

content strategy around non-Hindi and non-English segments.

The music industry is also seeing this shift. Platforms like Spotify and JioSaavn have tailored their offerings to include more regional music catering to a growing audience that seeks content in their native languages.

As the industry continues to evolve, these trends are expected to drive further growth, reshaping the landscape of Indian media and entertainment. The next decade promises to be one of continued innovation, as digitisation and regionalisation reshape media consumption, while consolidation pushes companies to strengthen their position in an increasingly competitive market. **BT**

Views are personal